

About

David Samuel · Founder & Director, Phantoma · San Diego, CA

I'm an independent game developer based in San Diego. I'm finishing an Associate's in Computer Science with a game-development focus, and I work primarily in **Unity 6 LTS with C#** – the same stack this entire project is built on. Before going independent I spent time at PlayStation San Diego in QA and on project coordination for the PlayStation Classics catalog; that's where I learned how games actually get built, shipped, and – just as often – broken. That QA background is why I care so much about a build that **runs**, not just a build that compiles.

The Studio

Phantoma is both the project and the studio. It started in early 2026 as a personal experiment in "what if a game world was just a nice place to be," and grew into a small operation: me as Director, with collaborators pulled in for specific systems – character pipeline, environment art, audio. We build character-driven explorable spaces designed to feel lived-in rather than grinded-through. The studio philosophy is simple: a world earns your time by being worth existing in, not by dangling the next reward.

A SHORT HISTORY

- **Jan 2026** – Phantoma starts as a web prototype (a character configurator + social hub concept).
- **Mar 2026** – character pipeline established: Mixamo-rigged, humanoid-retargeted avatars with hand-tuned animation.
- **Apr 2026** – Unity refactor begins for this course; Phase 1 draft ships the hub concept and movement prototype.
- **May 2026** – Phase 2: the first true playable slice – a textured chibi character exploring a lit low-poly city with full third-person controls, a HUD, and interactable landmarks.

My Role

As Director of a studio this size, "my role" covers nearly everything: design direction, the character and animation pipeline, engine and gameplay programming, build-and-deploy infrastructure, and keeping every moving part talking to the others. Day to day on *Phantoma* I'm writing C#, wiring scenes, reviewing assets, making scope calls, and shipping. For this project specifically I wrote all the gameplay code (movement, camera, interaction, HUD, and the editor tooling), assembled the scenes, and produced the builds.

Elsewhere

- davidfgamedev.itch.io – shipped games
- davidfgamedev.github.io – portfolio
- github.com/davidfgamedev – code

Enhanced from the Phase 1 draft: added studio history, clarified the Unity/C# stack, and expanded the role description.